Slim Geregeld Administratie

The KOR small business scheme: the calculation

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When the Dutch small business scheme saves you money and when it costs you

WHAT THE KOR IS

The small business scheme (kleineondernemersregeling, KOR) is a VAT exemption for businesses with turnover of no more than EUR 20,000 per calendar year. Under the KOR you charge your clients no VAT and you file no VAT returns. In exchange you can no longer reclaim the VAT on your costs and investments.

Whether that pays off depends mostly on who your clients are. Consumers cannot reclaim VAT; businesses can. That is why the same scheme works out differently per business.

THE CALCULATION WITH PRIVATE CLIENTS

I see this pattern in several files. A worked example with round amounts: your clients are consumers and pay EUR 12,100 in total per year. Your costs are EUR 2,000 plus EUR 420 VAT.

	Without KOR	With KOR
What clients pay	EUR 12,100	EUR 12,100
VAT you pay to the tax office	EUR 2,100	EUR 0
Costs after reclaiming VAT	EUR 2,000	EUR 2,420
What you keep	**EUR 8,000**	**EUR 9,680**

With consumer clients the KOR leaves you EUR 1,680 more in this example, because the price for the client stays the same and the VAT no longer goes to the Belastingdienst (Dutch tax authority).

THE CALCULATION WITH BUSINESS CLIENTS

Same costs, but now your clients are businesses. They pay EUR 10,000 plus VAT and reclaim that VAT themselves, so for them the VAT changes nothing.

	Without KOR	With KOR
Turnover excluding VAT	EUR 10,000	EUR 10,000
Costs after reclaiming VAT	EUR 2,000	EUR 2,420
What you keep	**EUR 8,000**	**EUR 7,580**

With business clients the KOR costs you EUR 420 in this example: exactly the VAT on your costs that you no longer get back. The same goes for the VAT on your bookkeeper's invoice, which becomes a real cost of 21 percent under the KOR.

APPLYING AND THE DEADLINE

You apply in Mijn Belastingdienst Zakelijk, the tax office's business portal, and only after you are registered as a VAT entrepreneur. The application must arrive at least 4 weeks before the start date. If you file VAT quarterly, the Belastingdienst gives 3 December as the example date to join from 1 January.

Within 8 weeks you receive a letter with the definitive start date. Until that letter arrives, you keep filing VAT returns.

Four people this year did not know at their intake whether the KOR suited them. The question that decides it fastest: do your clients pay the VAT themselves, or do they reclaim it?

WHO I AM

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I'm Kyle Bouwmeester, a Becon-registered bookkeeper (Becon 781794) and the owner of Slim Geregeld Administratie in Koog aan de Zaan. I keep the books, file the VAT returns and prepare the annual figures for freelancers and small businesses, including DAFT and DJTT entrepreneurs, in English.

The Compliance Plan for DAFT and DJTT entrepreneurs is EUR 79 per month excluding VAT if you are on the KOR, or EUR 149 per month excluding VAT with quarterly VAT returns, with a quarterly check of your equity.

See the prices: slim-geregeld.nl/daft/#pricing

Sources: Belastingdienst, Kleineondernemersregeling (KOR) and Aanmelden voor de KOR (belastingdienst.nl), November 2026; Slim Geregeld Administratie practice.